

The ruins of the 12th-century priory overlook the site of the earlier Anglo-Saxon monastery.

### Island excavations

The Viking raid in 793 did not end the Christian community at Lindisfarne. Monks continued to live there and, about 500 years later, a new priory was built on the site, the ruins of which can still be seen today. Archaeologists now run regular digs to uncover the layers of the island's history.

### Game of stones

This tiny piece of blue and white glass is a playing piece from a strategic board game a bit like chess called *tafl* (pronounced "taffle"). It may have been buried along with a wealthy local man or woman. The Vikings played a version of *tafl*, too—the game was popular all over northern Europe.



The "crown" of five white dots means this was probably a king piece.

### Viking ironware

Unlike materials such as cloth, iron tools and weapons can survive centuries underground. This Viking sword would once have had a leather binding around the handle to make it easier to grip, but that has rotted away, leaving the iron behind.



The cross guard protected the warrior's hand in battle.